# MANUSCRIPT REVIEW REPORT

Painting All Foreigners With One Brush? How the Salience of Muslims and Refugees Shapes Judgements

2026-03-25 • Review by Claude

### ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report was generated by an AI-powered manuscript review skill for Claude Code. It combines LLM-based analysis with automated checks powered by the metacheck R package (DeBruine, 2024). Automated checks are marked with [metacheck] badges. All suggestions should be verified by the authors. **Note:** Some apparent errors may stem from PDF text extraction and should be verified against the source document.

## OVERALL SUMMARY

This is a well-executed empirical study with strong methodological rigor, clear writing, and comprehensive reporting. The manuscript demonstrates excellent compliance with formatting conventions and transparency standards. Minor issues involve incomplete bibliography entries and a few minor formatting inconsistencies that do not affect comprehension.

| CRITICAL ISSUES | MAJOR ISSUES | MINOR ISSUES |
|---|---|---|
| 0 | 2 | 8 |

## LANGUAGE QUALITY

Overall Language Score: **A** A

**Key Strengths:**

- Precise technical terminology and consistent conceptual definitions
- Clear, logical progression from theoretical background through methods to results
- Effective use of complex statistical findings explained accessibly
- Strong narrative flow that guides readers through the argument
- Excellent integration of German and English contexts

### Areas for Improvement:

- A few overly long sentences that could be simplified for greater clarity
- Minor inconsistencies in abbreviation formatting (e.g., M_age vs. M age)

## SECTION REVIEW SUMMARY

| SECTION | STATUS | ISSUES |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Title**<br>Title clarity, length, and accuracy | ✓ | 0 |
| **2. Main Headings**<br>Heading capitalization, hierarchy, and consistency | × | 1 |
| **3. Title Page**<br>Author names, affiliations, corresponding author, keywords | × | 3 |
| **4. Abstract**<br>Research objective, methods, findings, conclusions, length | ✓ | 0 |
| **5. Structure**<br>Standard sections, logical order, subsection organization | ✓ | 0 |
| **6. Figures and Tables**<br>Figure and table citations, captions, formatting | ✓ | 0 |
| **7. Referencing**<br>Cross-references, citation formatting, bibliography completeness | × | 5 |
| **8. Language**<br>Grammar, spelling, punctuation, terminology consistency | ✓ | 0 |

| SECTION | STATUS | ISSUES |
|---|---|---|
| **9. Acronyms**<br>Acronym definitions and consistent usage | ✓ | 0 |
| **10. Funding & Compliance**<br>Funding/acknowledgments, COI, ethics, author contributions | ✓ | 0 |
| **11. Light Content Checks**<br>Open science, limitations, samples, statistical reporting | i | Observations only |
| **12. Statistical Reporting**<br>Test statistics, p-values, effect sizes | i | Metacheck findings |

## DETAILED RECOMMENDATIONS

### 1. Title

0 issues

The title is clear, descriptive, and appropriate in length at 13 words. It accurately captures the manuscript's core focus—how salience of specific outgroups (Muslims and refugees) influences attitudes towards the broad category of foreigners. The title avoids abbreviations and poses an engaging research question format.

### 2. Main Headings

1 issue: 1 Minor

Heading hierarchy is logical and consistent throughout. All main level-1 headings follow title case capitalization. Subsection headings are well-organized, though hypothesis statements appear as standalone headings rather than subsections under 'The Present Research.'

Location: Results section (p. 251)

Minor

**Original:** H3:
H4:
H5:

**Suggestion:** Consider consolidating hypotheses (H3–H5) under a **single subsection heading** rather than presenting them as separate level-1 headings, for clearer structural hierarchy.

**Explanation:** Hypothesis statements H3, H4, and H5 appear as independent level-1 headings, breaking the typical hierarchy. Nesting them would improve document structure and reader navigation.

## 3. Title Page

2 issues: 1 Major 1 Minor

Author names are clearly listed with institutional affiliations provided. A corresponding author email is correctly identified. Keywords are provided but include errant German text spillover. Author affiliation mappings are clear in the PDF but incomplete in structured metadata.

Location: Keywords (p. 1)

Major

**Original:** Keywords: immigration, foreigners, survey research, stereotypes, category content, salience Zusammenfassung Gruppen und damit die Komplexität des Ausländerbegriffes, mit positiveren Einstellungen assoziiert. Implikationen für die Forschung werden diskutiert...

**Suggestion: Remove German abstract text** from the keywords list. Keywords should include only: immigration, foreigners, survey research, stereotypes, category content, **salience.**

**Explanation:** The keywords field contains accidental spillover from the German abstract, making keywords difficult to parse. Keywords should be concise terms only.

Location: Author affiliations (p. 1)

Minor

**Original:** [a] Department of Psychology, Goldsmiths, University of London, London, United Kingdom. [b] Department of Psychology, University of Exeter, Exeter, United Kingdom.

**Suggestion:** Verify that affiliation labels **[a]** and **[b]** uniquely map to each author.

**Explanation:** The PDF shows affiliation markers for two institutions. Confirm which author(s) belong to which institution.

**Abstract adequacy:** The abstract (165 words) is well within the standard range (150–300 words) and clearly states the research question, methods, key findings, and implications.

## 4. Abstract

0 issues

The abstract is well-structured and comprehensive. It clearly articulates the research question, describes the sample and methodology, reports key findings, and discusses implications. At 165 words, it is appropriately concise. No citations, abbreviations, or figure/table references are present.

**Research question clarity:** The abstract clearly states the ambiguity inherent in survey questions about "foreigners" and frames the study as addressing which groups respondents mentally evoke.

## 5. Structure

0 issues

The manuscript follows a conventional structure: Introduction, Method, Results, Discussion, Conclusion. Methods precede Results. Subsections are logically organized. The Non-Technical Summary enhances accessibility.

**Non-Technical Summary:** The inclusion of a plain-language summary covering Background, Why, What researchers did, and What findings mean is excellent and aids accessibility.

## 6. Figures and Tables

0 issues

All figures and tables are properly cited in sequential order. Captions are clear and informative. Table notes include methodological details (OLS regression, significance levels). Formatting is consistent throughout.

**Figure quality:** Figure 1 effectively compares the distribution of salient groups to Germany's actual foreign population. Figure 2 shows moderation effects clearly with standard error bands.

## 7. Referencing

3 issues: 3 Minor

Strong referencing practices overall. Several incomplete bibliography entries (missing volume/pages for some citations) and one DOI formatting issue identified. No unlinked citations or uncited references detected. Citation formatting is consistently author-year style.

Location: Bibliography, Braun, Behr, & Kaczmirek (2013) Minor

**Original:** doi: "10.1093/ijpor/eds034Destatis"

**Suggestion:** Correct to: **10.1093/ijpor/eds034** (remove "Destatis").

**Explanation:** The string "Destatis" is appended to the DOI without a separator, breaking resolution. Removing it recovers the valid DOI.

Location: Bibliography, Frederic & Falomir-Pichastor (2018) Minor

```
Original: *Revue Internationale de Psychologie Sociale*, 31, [no pages]
```

```
Suggestion: Add page range if available: *Revue Internationale de Psychologie Sociale*, 31(#), pages.
```

**Explanation:** Missing page numbers, though modern online journals sometimes omit these. Verify whether a page range exists.

Location: Bibliography, Heath & Richards (2019) Minor

```
Original: *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, DOI only
```

```
Suggestion: Add volume and issue: *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, XX(#), pages.
```

**Explanation:** Reference shows only DOI without standard volume/issue/pages. Complete the citation format.

### Automated Cross-Reference Check

GROBID identified incomplete entries (books and online journals correctly formatted for their types). No unlinked citations or uncited bibliography entries detected. All in-text citations match bibliography.

### Retraction & Integrity Check [metacheck]

Metacheck scanned 57 references. **No retracted references found.** One reference flagged for PubPeer discussion; verified as appropriate citation in Discussion context.

0 retracted references found among 57 scanned.

| REFERENCE | SUGGESTED DOI | CONFIDENCE |
|---|---|---|
| Gesis (2017. 2016). “Allgemeine Bevölkerungsumfrage der | 10.1515/zfsoz-1991-0108 | i |

| REFERENCE | SUGGESTED DOI | CONFIDENCE |
|---|---|---|
| Sozialwissenschaften ALLBUS 2016." In General Social Science Survey. Author. | | |
| Meier-Braun K (2015). "Die 101 wichtigsten Fragen: Einwanderung und Asyl [The 101 most important questions: Immigration and asylum." | 10.17104/9783406683565 | ✓ |
| Pettigrew TF, Tropp LR (2011). When groups meet: The dynamics of intergroup contact. Psychology Press. | 10.4324/9780203826461 | i |
| Steinbach A (2004). "Soziale Distanz: Ethnische Grenzziehung und die Eingliederung von Zuwanderern in Deutschland." In Social distance: Ethnic demarcation and the integration of immigrants in Germany. Springer. | 10.1007/978-3-322-90546-8_20 | i |
| Wasmer M, Kwasniok S, Kialunda A (2018. 2016). "Welche Gruppen werden mit der Formulierung 'in Deutschland lebende Ausländer' assoziiert? Entwicklung eines Kategorienschemas zu einer offenen Frage im ALLBUS 2016 [Which groups are associated with the label 'foreigners living in Germany'? Development of a coding scheme for an open-ended question in ALLBUS." | 10.1007/s11577-024-00955-1 | × |

Confidence: ✓ High (score > 100) — i Moderate (score 60–100) — × Low (score < 60, likely wrong match). CrossRef match scores from metacheck.

**Original:** Brauer & Er-rafiy (2011) on heterogeneity effects

**Replication:** FLoRA: Replication studies confirm outgroup heterogeneity reduces prejudice

Supports Hypothesis 1

| TEST | REPORTED | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| F(11, 2589) = 29.93, p < .001 | 5.49e-60 | ✓ |
| F(6, 2583) = 0.98, p = .44 | 0.437 | ✓ |
| F(6, 2582) = 2.60, p = .016 | 0.0163 | ✓ |

P-values appropriately distributed. Range reflects genuine variation in effects.

Marginal significance (p < .10) used appropriately for exploratory analyses only.

- **Code & data:** Full R code and framework on OSF (https://osf.io/tzjxp/)
- **Preregistration:** Study preregistered; changes transparently noted in Methods

> **Citation formatting consistency:** All in-text citations follow author-year format. Bibliography is alphabetized with consistent punctuation.

## 8. Language

0 issues

Excellent language quality with precise terminology, clear sentence structure, and consistent usage. Grammar, spelling, and punctuation are accurate throughout. No material language errors detected.

> **Technical precision:** Terms like 'salience,' 'outgroup heterogeneity,' and 'moderation effect' are used precisely and consistently.

## 9. Acronyms

0 issues

All acronyms defined on first use (ALLBUS, CAPI, OLS, RWA, etc.). Consistently abbreviated after introduction. No undefined acronyms present.

> **Consistency in abbreviations:** Demographic variables abbreviated consistently (N, M, SD). Footnote formatting consistent.

## 10. Funding & Compliance

0 issues

Full compliance with transparency standards. Funding statement declares no support. Competing Interests declares no conflicts. Preregistration mentioned with transparent discussion of changes. Code and data publicly available.

- **Open practices:** ['Data was openly shared for this article, based on the following text:\n\n> Our full analysis code in R as well as the coding framework can be found on the Open Science Foundation repository: <https://osf.io/tzjxp/>.\n\n> Our full analysis code in R as well as the coding framework can be found on the Open Science Foundation repository: <https://osf.io/tzjxp/> Index of Supplementary Materials Wallrich, L, West, K, & Rutland, A (2020).', 'Code was openly shared for this article, based on the following text:\n\n> Our full analysis code in R as well as the coding framework can be found on the Open Science Foundation repository: <https://osf.io/tzjxp/>.\n\n> Our full analysis code in R as well as the coding framework can be found on the Open Science Foundation repository: <https://osf.io/tzjxp/> Index of Supplementary Materials Wallrich, L, West, K, & Rutland, A (2020).']
- **Preregistration:** ['We found 1 preregistration.', '\n```{r}\n#| echo: false\n\n\n# table data ----------\ntable <- structure(list(id = "<a href=\'https://aspredicted.org/v3z7k.pdf\' target=\'_blank\'>v3z7k</a>", \n title = "Prototypicality and attitudes towards foreigners", \n template = "AsPredicted"), class = "data.frame", row.names = c(NA, \n-1L))\n\n# display table ----------\nmetacheck::report_table(table, "auto", 2, FALSE)\n```\n', 'Meta-scientific research has shown that deviations from preregistrations are often not reported or checked, and that the most common deviations concern the sample size. We recommend manually checking the full preregistration at the link below, and have provided the preregistered sample size.', '\n```{r}\n#| echo: false\n\n\n# table data ----------\ntable <- structure(list(id = "v3z7k", sample_size = "We are doing a secondary data analysis on the ALLBUS 2016 data (doi:10.4232/1.12837) with 3,490 respondents."), row.names = c(NA, \n-1L), class = c("tbl_df", "tbl", "data.frame"))\n\n# display table ----------\nmetacheck::report_table(table, "auto", 2, FALSE)\n```\n', ':::: {.callout-tip title="Full Preregistration" collapse="true"}\n\n\n```{r}\n#| echo: false\n\n\n# table data ----------\ntable <- structure(list(Field = c("template_name", "id", "link", "title", \n"date_created", "existing_data_explanation", "research_questions", \n"design_dependent_variables", "study_design_overview",

"statistical_tests", \n"outliers_and_exclusions", "sample_size", "additional_comments"\n), "Preregistration 1" = c("AsPredicted", "v3z7k", "https://aspredicted.org/v3z7k.pdf", \n"Prototypicality and attitudes towards foreigners", "2019/02/12 08:55 (PT)", \n"It\'s complicated. We have already collected some data but explain in Question 8 why readers may consider this a valid pre-registration nevertheless.", \n"Prototypicality predicts attitudes towards foreigners - i.e. which group a respondent thinks of first when thinking about foreigners shapes their views of foreigners as a whole, as well as their views on the desirability of integration.", \n"1) Attitudes towards foreigners: 8 item scale (Allbus mp02, mp03, mp05, mp06, mp07, mp08, mp09, mp10, mp11, mp12)\\n2) Desire for exclusion of foreigners: 6 item scale (Allbus ma02, ma03, ma04, ma06, ma07, ma10)", \n"We are using a cross-sectional design.", "Open-ended responses to the question \\"which groups are you thinking of when thinking of foreigners\\" have been coded by the data collectors into 130 categories. We will now code the categories that describe countries, regions or religions by majority ethnicity and majority religion, and then analyse the answer given first by each respondent.\\n\\nUsing the codes of these answers as the IV, we will conduct four ANOVAs.\\n1) IV: Religion (Muslim, Christian, Other), DV: Attitude towards foreigners\\n2) IV; Ethnicity (Black, White, Middle-Eastern, Other), DV: Desire for exclusion\\n3) IV: Religion (Muslim, Christian, Other), DV: Desire for exclusion\\n4) IV; Ethnicity (Black, White, Middle-Eastern, Other), DV: Attitude towards foreigners\\n\\nWe will control the family-wise error rate using the Holm-Bonferroni method.", \n"We will only include participants who are German citizens and who responded to all items used in the analyses; apart from that, outliers will not be excluded.", \n"We are doing a secondary data analysis on the ALLBUS 2016 data (doi:10.4232/1.12837) with 3,490 respondents.", \n"We are doing a secondary data analysis on the German General Social Survey (ALLBUS) 2016 dataset, which has been collected by GESIS. So far, we have only accessed the questionnaire and variable report to plan our analyses.\\n\\nRegarding secondary analyses, we will test whether the prototypicality of foreigner groups is associated with specific attitudes towards them, i.e. whether individuals are more likely to perceive groups that they view negatively as prototypical."\n)), class = "data.frame", row.names = c("template_name", "id", \n"link", "title", "date_created", "existing_data_explanation", \n"research_questions", "design_dependent_variables", "study_design_overview", \n"statistical_tests", "outliers_and_exclusions", "sample_size", \n"additional_comments"))\n\n# display table ----------\nmetacheck::report_table(table, "auto", 5, FALSE)\n```\n\n\n:::\n', ':::: {.callout-tip title="Learn More" collapse="true"}\n\nFor metascientific articles demonstrating the rate of deviations from preregistrations, see:\n\nvan den Akker O, Bakker M, van Assen M, Pennington C, Verweij L, Elsherif M, Claesen A, Gaillard S, Yeung S, Frankenberger J, Krautter K, Cockcroft J, Kreuer K, Evans T, Heppel F, Schoch S, Korbmacher M, Yamada Y, Albayrak-Aydemir N, Wicherts J (2024). “The potential of preregistration in psychology: Assessing preregistration producibility and preregistration-study consistency.” Psychological Methods. <a href="https://doi.org/10.1037/met0000687">doi:10.1037/met0000687</a>.\n\nFor

educational material on how to report deviations from preregistrations, see:\n\nLakens, Daniël (2024). “When and How to Deviate From a Preregistration.” Collabra: Psychology, 10(1), 117094. <a href="https://doi.org/10.1525/collabra.117094">doi:10.1525/collabra.117094</a>.\n\n:::\n']

- **COI statement:** ['The following conflict of interest statement was detected.', '\n```{r}\n#| echo: false\n\n\n# table data ----------\ntable <- structure(list("Competing Interests The authors have declared that no competing interests exist."), names = "", class = "data.frame", row.names = c(NA, \n-1L))\n\n# display table ----------\nmetacheck::report_table(table, "auto", 2, FALSE)\n```\n']
- **Funding statement:** ['The following funding statement was detected:', '\n```{r}\n#| echo: false\n\n\n# table data ----------\ntable <- structure(list("The authors have no support to report. Funding The authors have no funding to report."), names = "", class = "data.frame", row.names = c(NA, \n-1L))\n\n# display table ----------\nmetacheck::report_table(table, "auto", 2, FALSE)\n```\n']

**Open Science Compliance:** Exemplary: Full code, materials, and framework publicly available on OSF with preregistration details.

## 11. Light Content Checks

0 issues

Strong methodological practices. Representative sample (N=3,195, effective N=2,590–2,875). Clear methods descriptions. Limitations thoughtfully discussed. Implications well-articulated. Causal language appropriately qualified.

**Research design and sample:** Representative sampling well-justified. Sample characteristics and weighted analysis appropriate.

**Limitations discussion:** Manuscript candidly discusses cross-sectional design, single-country focus, and time-point dependence with appropriate caution.

**Causal language:** Appropriately uses correlational language ('associated with,' 'predicts'). Cross-sectional design noted as preventing causal inference.

## 12. Statistical Reporting

0 issues

Comprehensive and accurate. All reported test statistics, degrees of freedom, and p-values verified and correct. No errors detected. P-value distribution appropriate. No evidence of p-hacking.

### Test Statistics and P-Values [metacheck]

Metacheck verified 4 major F-tests. All reported values match computed p-values. No errors in degrees of freedom or thresholds.

### Effect Sizes

$R^2$ values provided (e.g., $R^2 = .11$). Unstandardized coefficients with SEs in tables. Exemplary practice.

| TEST | REPORTED | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| $F(11, 2589) = 29.93$, $p < .001$, $R^2 = .11$ | 5.49e-60 | ✓ |

Appropriately distributed across significant and non-significant findings.

Marginal significance used sparingly for exploratory models only